

MONITORING HAZARDS & DISASTERS WORLDWIDE SINCE 1988

EM-DAT contains data on the occurrence and impacts of over 27,000 mass disasters worldwide from 1900 to the present day. The database is compiled from various sources, including UN agencies, non-governmental organizations, reinsurance companies, research institutes, and press agencies. The **Centre for Research on the Epidemiology of Disasters (CRED)** distributes the data in **open access** for non-commercial use.

Support EM-DAT. Protect disaster data.

 Sign the open letter

 Access the data

 Documentation

LATEST NEWS

What's new?

Check our latest news by clicking on the slides or explore our entire news or publication repository.



EM-DAT OVERVIEW

MORE THAN 27,000 DISASTER RECORDS

EM-DAT defines disasters as situations or events which overwhelm local capacity, necessitating a request for external assistance at the national or international level. Disasters are unforeseen and often sudden events that cause significant damage, destruction, and human suffering.

The main objective of the database is to serve the purposes of **humanitarian action at national and international levels**. The initiative aims to rationalize decision-making for **disaster preparedness** and **disaster risk reduction strategies**, as well as provide an objective base for **vulnerability assessment and priority setting**.

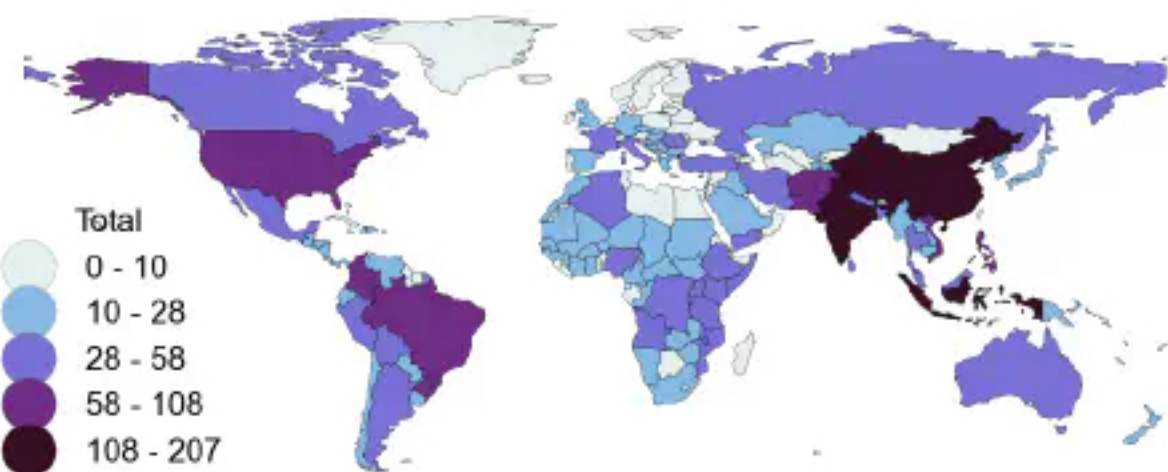
INCLUSION CRITERIA

EM-DAT focuses on major disasters

EM-DAT globally records at the country level **human and economic losses** for disasters with at least one of the following criteria:

- 10 fatalities;
- 100 affected people;
- a declaration of state of emergency;
- a call for international assistance.

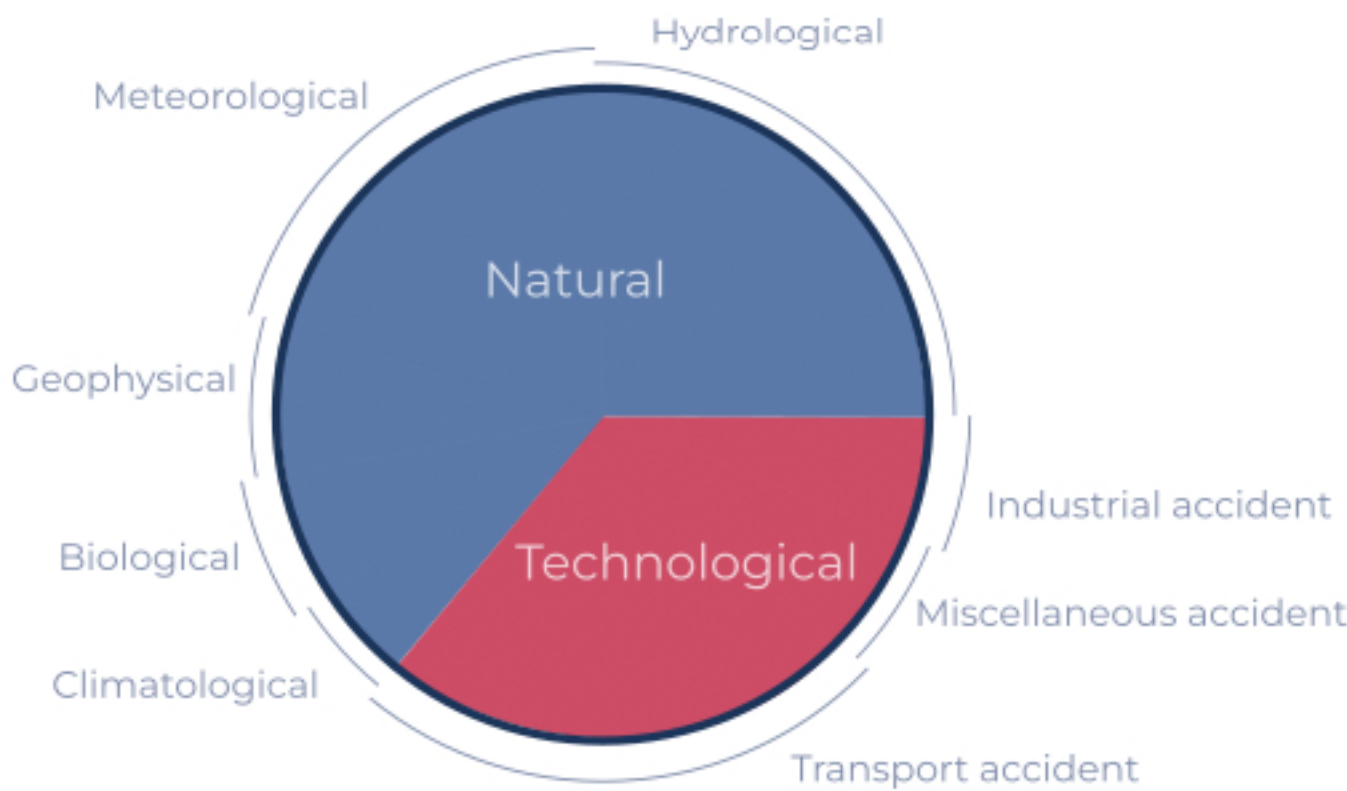
Flood occurrence per country (2000-2022)



DISASTER CLASSIFICATION

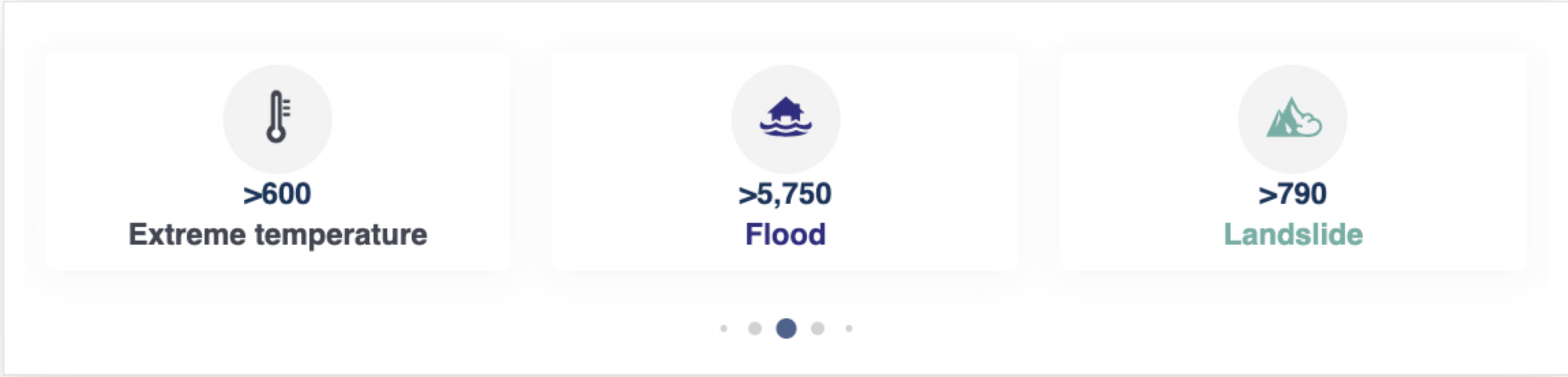
EM-DAT adopts a hierarchical classification

The database classifies disasters into two groups of hazards: **natural** and **technological**. The natural group is further classified up to four additional levels following the 2014 IRDR Peril Classification and Hazard Glossary. The technological group is less detailed and comprises three main types: transport, industrial, and miscellaneous accidents.



EM-DAT IN NUMBERS

About 2/3 of disasters in EM-DAT are related to natural hazards



“EM-DAT is vital for managing disaster risks, aiding in my research on socio-economic impacts since 2007. Without EM-DAT my career would have been completely different”
Ilan Noy, Victoria University of Wellington (New Zealand)

“EM-DAT is critical to climate change research, offering unmatched data quality and fostering open science.”
Wim Thiery, VUB (Belgium)

“As a climate scientist, EM-DAT is essential for understanding the relationship between climate change and disasters.”
Aglae Jezequel, IRSS (Belgium)

ABOUT US

BEHIND EM-DAT

A long-term expertise

The Emergency Events Database EM-DAT was created in 1988 as a joint initiative between the **Centre for Research on the Epidemiology of Disasters (CRED)** and the World Health Organization (WHO). The CRED is now part of the Institute of Health and Society attached to the University of Louvain (UCLouvain). For more than 25 years, the EM-DAT database and project have been primarily sponsored by the United States Agency for International Development (USAID).

HOST INSTITUTION



Socials



Mail us to subscribe to our newsletter

 subscribe

Quick Links

- Data portal
- Documentation
- CRED website
- Terms & Conditions

Location & Contact

Centre for Research on the Epidemiology of Disasters
Institute of Health & Society (IRSS)
Université catholique de Louvain
Clos Chapelle-aux-Champs, Bte B1.30.15, 1200 Brussels, Belgium
 contact@cred.be